

## Chapter 70 - Part 3

Zhou Yi'an met Su Yao when she was studying abroad. Back then, she was sent out of the country for high school and was quite lost.

She met Su Yao while wandering the streets. Su Yao could only see with one eye and often wore sunglasses. She would wander around on roads covered with fallen leaves, sit on benches in a daze, and sit there for an entire afternoon.

Later, Zhou Yi'an sat there and drew her portrait.

After seeing it, Su Yao said: "Let me teach you to draw other things."

At the time, she thought this woman was crazy.

Although she later discovered that this woman indeed had a condition.

But during those boring and confused days, it was Su Yao who taught her many things, and she ended up majoring in design in college.

Without Su Yao, there wouldn't be the Zhou Yi'an of today.

Zhou Yi'an had thought she was just an ordinary crazy person. After all, people who do art are all somewhat abnormal to varying degrees.

But later she discovered that things weren't as simple as she thought.

There were many versions of Su Yao's story available with just a search online.

Her love story with the genius architectural designer Sheng Qinglin was hyped up everywhere.

It wasn't until she met Su Zhe that she mentioned the name Sheng Qinglin.

Su Zhe said with disgust: "Inauspicious<sup>1</sup>."

He repeatedly warned her not to mention this name in front of Su Yao.

But later, when Su Yao became slightly more lucid, she changed her name to Su Mu.

She said Su Yao was dead, and the one who survived was Su Mu.

"Mu" was formed by taking half of each character from "Qinglin<sup>2</sup>."

She would live the rest of her life carrying Sheng Qinglin with her.

Zhou Yi'an had once been curious about Su Yao's story, but out of respect, she suppressed this curiosity.

It was later, when she investigated Xu Qingzhu on a whim, that she saw a familiar name—Sheng Qinglin.

With just a little attention to piecing together the rumors in certain circles, one would know that back then, the famous Sheng Linlang of Haizhou had become pregnant before marriage. Some said she was indiscreet, others said the child wasn't hers.

Then Zhou Yi'an obtained a strand of Xu Qingzhu's hair and had it tested against Su Yao's DNA.

She always preferred straightforward methods of verification.

Then she also tested Xu Qingzhu's DNA against Sheng Yu's.

Xu Qingzhu was the daughter of Su Yao and Sheng Qinglin.

Sheng Yu was Xu Qingzhu's biological younger sister.

And Sheng Yu, as the child Su Yao desperately gave birth to while commemorating Sheng Qinglin, actually existed in another form.

But Su Yao didn't remember.

She had once been diagnosed with mental instability. After being stimulated, she lost her memories and didn't even recognize her own brother, only remembering Sheng Qinglin.

It took many years before she recovered to her current state.

Xu Qingzhu must have heard those rumors too. Moreover, when she said that sentence in the interview room just now, what she meant was—fated but not meant to be together<sup>3</sup>, I don't want to know about Su Yao's relationship with me.

She must have guessed something.

She guessed it, but suppressed her curiosity and didn't verify it.

She was a person who was calm and rational to the point of being almost cold.

Zhou Yi'an had thought Su Meiqi knew something and that's why she came to this company, but it seemed she was overthinking.

Moreover, Zhou Yi'an had just prepared herself to mock Xu Qingzhu.

About not caring about her biological mother, things like that.

But she didn't want to hear anything.

Zhou Yi'an didn't say it either.

There are boundaries in interactions between adults.

Perhaps she had previously thought about hurting her, but after knowing she was her teacher's daughter...

Zhou Yi'an only had ten thousand curse words she wanted to say.

If only she had investigated earlier.

After the meeting ended, around noon, Xu Qingzhu directly said: "Designer Zhou, please stay behind."

Zhou Yi'an placed her phone screen-down on the table. "What is it?"

"I saw you had something to say to me." Xu Qingzhu said: "Let's have lunch together."

Zhou Yi'an: "....."

She had nothing to say.

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### Footnotes:

<sup>1</sup> **Inauspicious (晦氣)** - A Chinese term meaning unlucky, ill-omened, or bringing bad luck; expressing strong disgust or the feeling that something/someone brings misfortune.

<sup>2</sup> **"Mu" formed by taking half of each character from "Qinglin" (「清林」各取一半是為沐)** - In Chinese characters, "清" (Qing) contains the water radical "氵" and "林" (Lin) contains the wood/tree component "木". Taking the water radical from "清" (氵) and the wood component from "林" (木) creates the character "沐" (Mu), which means "to wash" or "to bathe," symbolically representing that Su Yao is washing/bathing herself in the memory of Sheng Qinglin for the rest of her life.

<sup>3</sup> **Fated but not meant to be together (有緣無分)** - A Chinese idiom describing a relationship where two people are destined to meet (have fate/yuan) but are not meant to be together or have a deep relationship (lack the portion/share/fen that would bind them together).